



**UNIT  
15**



**POEMS**

## UNIT 15 POEMS

### "Leisure"

**William Henry Davies** (1871–1940) was a Welsh poet and writer. Known as the "Tramp Poet," Davies often wrote about the struggles of the poor and the beauty of nature. His reflective and simple style appeals to readers of all ages.

What is this life if, full of care,  
We have no time to stand and stare?  
No time to stand beneath the boughs,  
And stare as long as sheep or cows.

No time to see, when woods we pass,  
Where squirrels hide their nuts in grass.  
No time to see, in broad daylight,  
Streams full of stars, like skies at night.

No time to turn at Beauty's glance,  
And watch her feet, how they can dance.  
No time to wait till her mouth can,  
Enrich that smile her eyes began.

A poor life this if, full of care,  
We have no time to stand and stare.

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## 1. Comprehension Questions

- What does the poet mean by "No time to stand and stare"?
- How does the poet describe nature in the poem?
- Why does the poet call life "poor" if it's full of care?

## 2. Vocabulary Building

- Define the following words: boughs, enrich, glance.
- Use each word in your own sentence.

## 3. Critical Thinking

- Do you agree with the poet that life is "poor" if we don't have time to appreciate nature? Why or why not?

## 4. Creative Task

- Draw an illustration of your favorite part of nature (a tree, a river, the sky, etc.), inspired by the poem.
- Write about a moment when you "stood and stared" at something beautiful and share with your classmates.

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## "Don't Quit"

The author of this inspirational poem remains **unknown**, yet their words have resonated across generations. The poem encourages perseverance, offering timeless advice to stay resilient even in the toughest of times.

When things go wrong as they sometimes will,  
When the road you're trudging seems all uphill,  
When the funds are low, and the debts are high,  
And you want to smile, but you have to sigh.

When care is pressing you down a bit,  
Rest, if you must, but don't you quit.  
Life is queer with its twists and turns,  
As every one of us sometimes learns.

Success is failure turned inside out,  
The silver tint of the clouds of doubt.  
And you never can tell how close you are,  
It may be near when it seems afar.

So stick to the fight when you're hardest hit,  
It's when things seem worst that you mustn't quit.

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## 1. Comprehension Questions

- What is the central theme of this poem?
- How does the poet describe success?
- Why does the poet encourage sticking to the fight during difficult times?

## 2. Vocabulary Building

- Define the following: trudging, pressing, queer.
- Use each word in a sentence that reflects its meaning.

## 3. Critical Thinking

- Share an example from your life when you didn't quit and achieved your goal. How did it make you feel?

## 4. Creative Task

- Create a motivational poster using a line from this poem, such as "Stick to the fight when you're hardest hit."
- Write your own four-line poem encouraging someone not to give up.

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## A New Year's Resolution

**Joanna Khalid Mehar** is a contemporary Pakistani poetess known for her motivational and reflective poems. Her works focus on self-improvement, hope, and the beauty of transformation, inspiring readers to embrace positivity and change.

The clock strikes twelve, a brand-new start,  
A chance to mend a weary heart.  
The past is gone, its lessons stay,  
As dawn unveils another day.

I'll cast my fears into the sea,  
Embrace the change that sets me free.  
With every step, a promise made,  
To weave my dreams, unafraid.

This year, I'll seek the joy I crave,  
And tread with courage, bold and brave.  
For resolutions aren't just lines,  
They're seeds of hope the heart defines.

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## 1. Comprehension Questions

- What does the poet mean by “The past is gone, its lessons stay”?
- Why does the poet describe resolutions as “seeds of hope”?

## 2. Vocabulary Building

- Define the following words: weary, unveil, unafraid.
- Use each word in a sentence.

## 3. Critical Thinking

- Why do you think it’s important to make resolutions?
- What would you like to achieve in the new year?

## 4. Creative Task

- Write your own New Year’s resolution in two to four lines of poetry and share with the class.
- Draw a clock striking twelve and write your resolution around it.